

U.S. Undergraduate Health Science Curriculum Trends

Research date: June 18, 2026

Scope: Eight official U.S. undergraduate Health Science / Health Sciences catalog and program pages

This brief is intended as a benchmarking aid for faculty curriculum planning. Official catalogs and program pages were prioritized. Specific course requirements and credit rules may change by academic year.

Executive Summary

1. **Pre-health plus flexible pathway structures are becoming standard.** UF, UCF, DePaul, and Stockton explicitly organize programs around pre-professional tracks or concentrations.
2. **Applied learning is a major differentiator.** Drexel requires a six-month co-op option, UCF offers an 80-hour/3-credit internship, UMN Rochester uses a personalized capstone, and UF and DePaul include capstone expectations.
3. **Public health, health systems, policy, and ethics are moving into the core.** Programs are no longer framed only as basic science preparation for professional school; they increasingly require healthcare system literacy.
4. **Research, statistics, and data literacy are expanding.** Drexel, Ohio State, Stockton, and UCF explicitly include research methods, statistics, informatics, or epidemiology.
5. **Health equity, community health, and interprofessional education are emerging as identity markers.** Stockton foregrounds IPEC-based preparation, while Quinnipiac highlights interprofessional education and a Health Equity minor.
6. **Microcredentials and short certification experiences are rising.** Quinnipiac highlights EMT,

Mental Health First Aid, healthcare quality and safety, and microcredential opportunities.

Comparison Snapshot

Institution	Program Structure	Curriculum Signals	Useful Adaptation
University of Florida	Bachelor of Health Science, 120 credits, four specializations	SLO/curriculum map, capstone portfolio/exam, public health core	Connect program outcomes to a course map and formal capstone assessment.
Drexel University	BS Health Sciences, 183 quarter credits, one co-op option	Six-month co-op, research methods, statistics, ethics, public health, simulation	Position fieldwork as a graduation requirement or high-value restricted elective.
Ohio State University	BS Health Sciences, professional curriculum plus required minor	Pathophysiology, epidemiology, research, healthcare statistics, ethics, management	Use a required or recommended minor to preserve career flexibility.
DePaul University	BS Health Sciences, Bioscience and Public Health Sciences concentrations	Capstone, health ethics, public health, policy, multiple accelerated pathways	Explore undergraduate-to-graduate accelerated pathway options.
University of Minnesota Rochester	BSHS, six focus areas	Health technology, public health, mental health, personalized capstone	Introduce a capstone proposal plus final reflection sequence.
Stockton University	BSHS, General / Pre-PA / Pre-OT / Pre-PT concentrations	IPEC foundation, informatics, service-learning ethics/teamwork,	Use interprofessional collaborative practice as a program identity.

Institution	Program Structure	Curriculum Signals	Useful Adaptation
		research	
University of Central Florida	BS Health Sciences, Pre- Clinical and Health Promotion tracks	Research methods, pharmacology, epidemiology, 80-hour internship	Offer an 80+ hour field experience as a 3-credit restricted elective.
Quinnipiac University	BS Health Science Studies	EMT, Mental Health First Aid, microcredentials, IPE, Health Equity minor	Pair short credential modules with curricular or co-curricular portfolios.

Curriculum Ideas to Apply

One-Semester Pilots

- Add a **Health Systems, Policy, and Ethics** module to an existing introductory or sophomore-level major course.
- Add a **Health Data Literacy** mini-module that combines statistics, epidemiology, digital health, and AI/data interpretation through cases.
- Use **interprofessional teamwork** as a team-based case analysis assignment rather than a one-time guest lecture.

One-Year Revisions

- Design a capstone menu with options in research, internship, community project, or portfolio.
- Start with two or three tracks from these options: Pre-Clinical, Public/Community Health, Health Data and Technology, Rehabilitation/Exercise, and Healthcare Management.
- Make at least two of the following visible in required coursework: research methods, statistics, epidemiology, informatics.

Program-Level Changes

- State health equity, interprofessional collaboration, communication, and evidence-based practice as program outcomes, then map them to courses.
- Expand fieldwork beyond hospital shadowing to include community health, nonprofits, health technology, research labs, and public health agencies.
- Introduce short microcredential or certificate elements so students graduate with visible portfolio artifacts.

Caveats

- The sample size is limited, so the findings should be read as benchmarking signals rather than a national generalization.
- Some institutions provide more detail on program pages than in catalog pages; both were used when official.
- Credit requirements, prerequisites, and graduation rules can change annually. Recheck current catalogs before drafting a formal revision proposal.

Official Sources

- University of Florida Catalog: https://catalog.ufl.edu/UGRD/colleges-schools/UGPBH/HES_BHS/
- Drexel University Catalog: <https://catalog.drexel.edu/undergraduate/collegeofnursingandhealthprofessions/healthsciences/>
- Ohio State University: <https://hrs.osu.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/health-sciences/curriculum>
- DePaul University Catalog: <https://catalog.depaul.edu/programs/health-sciences-bs/>
- University of Minnesota Rochester: <https://r.umn.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/bachelor-science-health-sciences>
- Stockton University: <https://stockton.edu/health-sciences/health-science.html>
- University of Central Florida: <https://healthprofessions.ucf.edu/healthsciences/bachelors/>
- Quinnipiac University: <https://www.qu.edu/schools/health-sciences/programs/bachelors-degree/health-science-studies/>